

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Shankaranand Bodla

Address: 10 Wyndham Close Sutton Sutton SM2 6JF

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:- Increased Traffic & Road Safety Risks

The proposed development is likely to generate a substantial increase in vehicle movements in surrounding residential streets. It is estimated that 70 or more vehicles could seek parking on nearby roads, with the potential for up to 80 vehicles present locally during peak overlap periods (for example, when one event finishes and another begins).

This level of additional traffic would:

- Intensify congestion on already narrow residential streets

- Lead to unsafe parking on corners, pavements, and across driveways

- Increase vehicle turning movements and reversing in confined spaces

- Create hazards for pedestrians, cyclists, and local residents

Such pressure on local infrastructure significantly raises the risk of minor collisions, near misses, and blocked emergency access routes.

- School Safety Concerns

Avenue Primary Academy serves approximately 1,034 pupils, resulting in substantial pedestrian and vehicle activity during morning drop-off and afternoon pick-up periods.

The addition of event-related traffic would:

- Increase congestion during peak school travel times

- Reduce sightlines for drivers and pedestrians due to on-street parking

- Heighten the risk of children stepping into traffic from between parked vehicles

Complicate safe crossing for families walking to and from school

Children are particularly vulnerable road users. Even small increases in traffic and parking density can materially elevate the risk of accidents in school zones.

- Serious Noise and Late-Night Disturbance

Events involving up to 250 attendees, dispersing around 11:00pm, would likely create repeated late-night disturbances.

This disturbance is not limited to amplified sound from within the venue, but includes:

Groups congregating and talking loudly outside

Car engines idling and revving

Doors slamming

Vehicles circling repeatedly while searching for parking spaces

Car stereos and horns

Noise at this time of night travels further and is more intrusive due to lower ambient background sound. Repeated weekly or regular events would have a cumulative negative impact on residents' sleep, wellbeing, and quality of life.

- Impact on Vulnerable Residents

The area includes a nearby care home and a significant number of elderly residents, who are particularly sensitive to disruption.

The likely impacts include:

Blocked access for carers, ambulances, and essential services

Increased difficulty for residents with limited mobility navigating obstructed pavements

Heightened anxiety caused by congestion and late-night activity

Greater health impact from sleep disturbance

For elderly and vulnerable individuals, even moderate increases in noise and access obstruction can have disproportionate effects on physical and mental wellbeing.

- Visually Overbearing and Out of Character

The proposed extensions and increased building height would result in a structure that is:

Visually dominant within the streetscape

Out of scale with neighbouring two-storey domestic properties

Inconsistent with the established residential character of the area

The development would alter the street's appearance from a predominantly domestic setting to one defined by a larger, more imposing institutional-style building. This would undermine the visual cohesion of the neighbourhood and negatively affect residential amenity.